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FUNDAMENTALS OF MANAGEMENT AND ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR

Week 11 – Motivation

MNT 215 – Summer 2026

Suliman S. Olayan School of Business | American University of Beirut





WHAT IS MOTIVATION?

- **Motivation:** the process by which a person's efforts are energized, directed, and sustained toward attaining a goal
- This definition has three key elements:
 1. Energy
 2. Direction
 3. Persistence

EARLY THEORIES OF MOTIVATION



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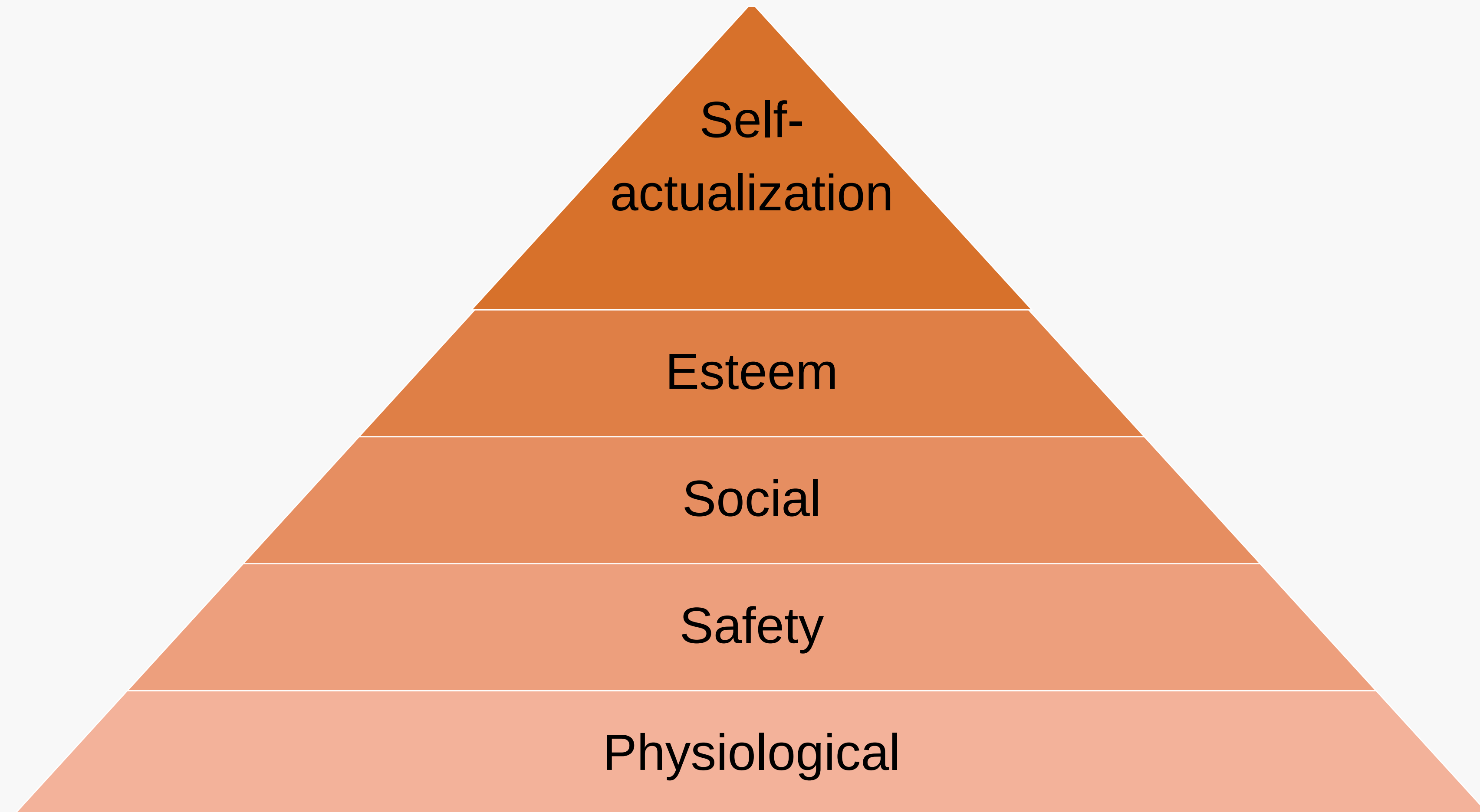


MASLOW'S HIERARCHY OF NEEDS THEORY

Hierarchy of needs theory: Maslow's theory that human needs—physiological, safety, social, esteem, and self-actualization—form a hierarchy and that each level in the needs hierarchy must be substantially satisfied before the next need becomes dominant



MASLOW'S HIERARCHY OF NEEDS



MASLOW'S PYRAMID: SOME LIMITS

This theory was very popular in the 1960s and 1970s

However, there is...

- Very **little evidence** found for the ranking of needs that Maslow described, or even for the existence of a definite hierarchy at all (Wabha & Bridwell, 1976).
- **Little support** for the prepotent nature of needs and the utility of need theories more generally (Kanfer et al., 2017)
- They do not predict specific behaviors (Campbell & Pritchard, 1976).

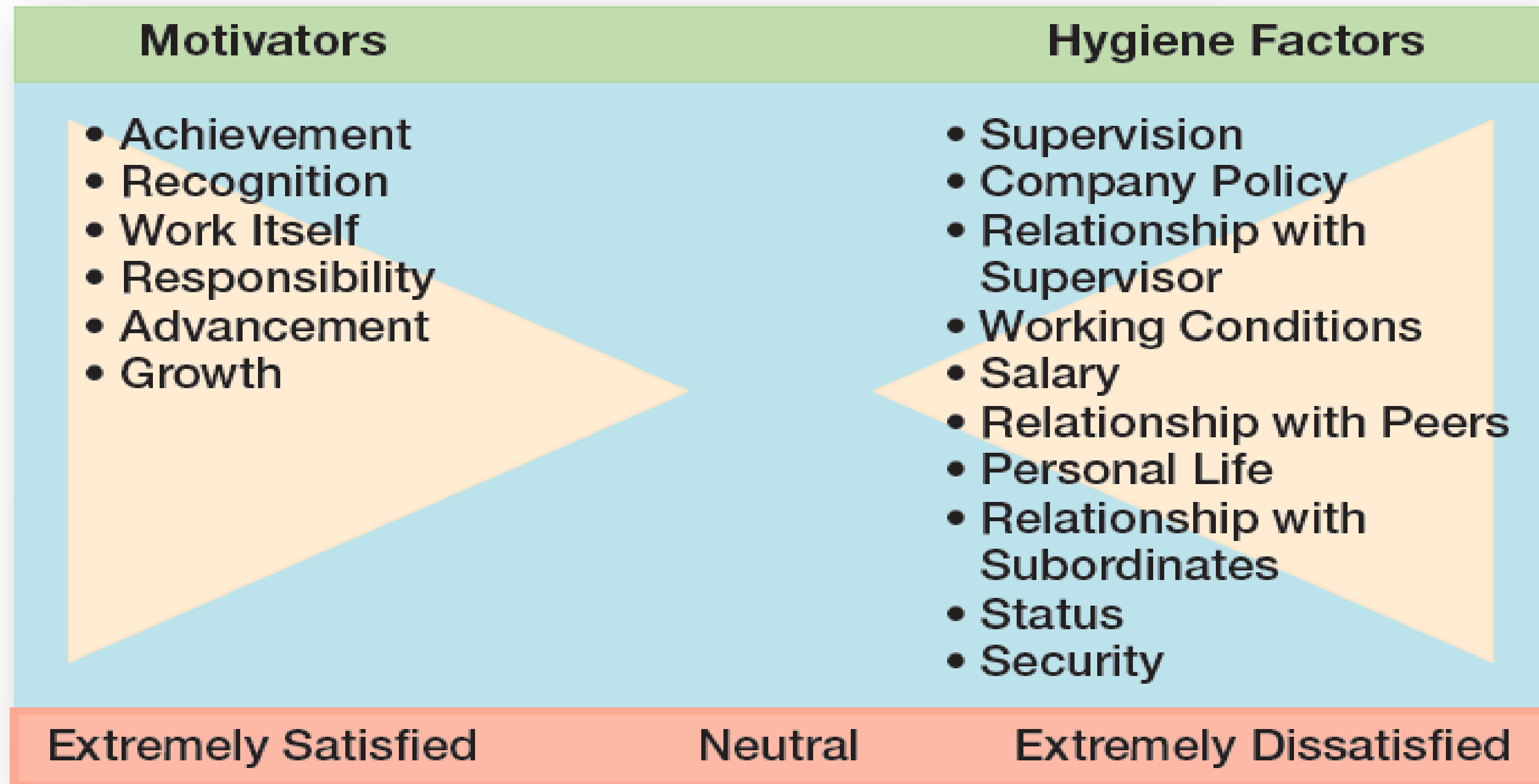


HERZBERG'S TWO-FACTOR THEORY

- **Two-factor theory (motivation-hygiene theory):** the motivation theory that intrinsic factors are related to job satisfaction and motivation, whereas extrinsic factors are associated with job dissatisfaction
- **Hygiene factors:** the extrinsic factors that remove job dissatisfaction
- **Motivators:** the intrinsic factors having to do with the job itself

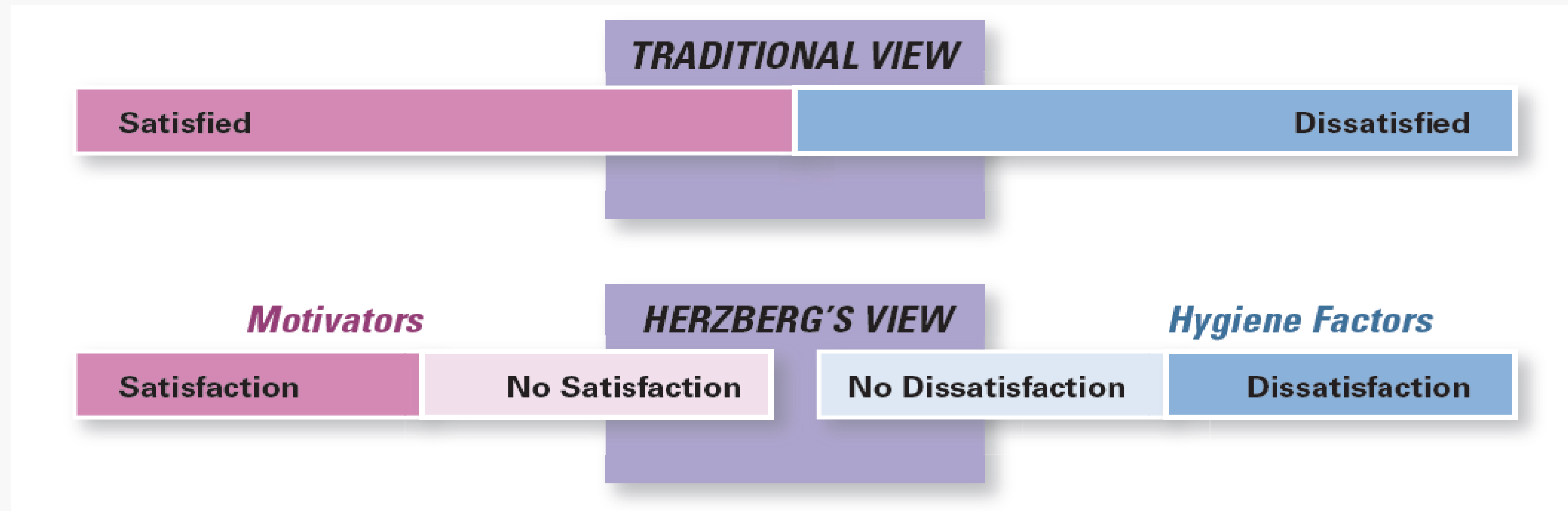


HERZBERG'S TWO-FACTOR THEORY





CONTRASTING VIEWS OF SATISFACTION AND DISSATISFACTION





HERZBERG'S TWO-FACTOR THEORY: SOME LIMITS

- Used of the **critical incident method**: “Recall times when you felt good or bad about your job”
- This method introduced self-serving bias
- Herzberg's original samples were **white-collar professionals**
- Studies with **blue-collar workers** have not always replicated his findings



THREE-NEEDS THEORY (1 OF 2)

- **Three-needs theory:** the motivation theory that says three acquired (not innate) needs— achievement, power, and affiliation—are major motives in work



THREE-NEEDS THEORY (2 OF 2)

- **Need for achievement (nAch):** the drive to succeed and excel in relation to a set of standards
- **Need for power (nPow):** the need to make others behave in a way that they would not have behaved otherwise
- **Need for affiliation (nAff):** the desire for friendly and close interpersonal relationships



THREE-NEEDS THEORY: EVIDENCE

Research shows some relationships between nAch and job performance.
Employees high on nAch:

- Exhibit more positive moods and greater interest in the task at hand.
- Perform very well in high-stakes conditions on the job.
- Research also supports nPow and nAff concepts.

MODERN THEORIES OF MOTIVATION



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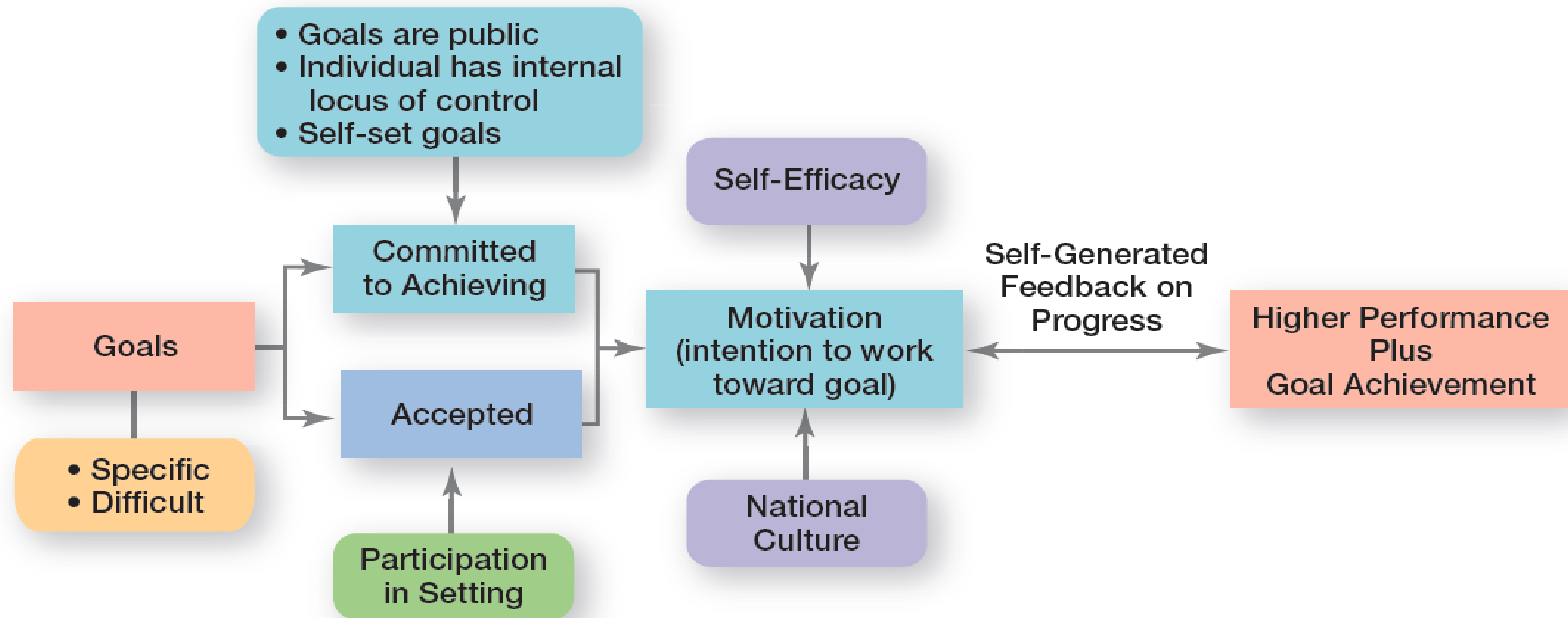


GOAL-SETTING THEORIES

- **Goal-setting theory:** the proposition that specific goals increase performance and that difficult goals, when accepted, result in higher performance than do easy goals
- **Self-efficacy:** an individual's belief that he or she is capable of performing a task



GOAL-SETTING THEORY





DESIGNING MOTIVATING JOBS (1 OF 2)

- **Job design:** the way tasks are combined to form complete jobs
- **Job scope:** the number of different tasks required in a job and the frequency with which those tasks are repeated
- **Job enlargement:** the horizontal expansion of a job by increasing job scope

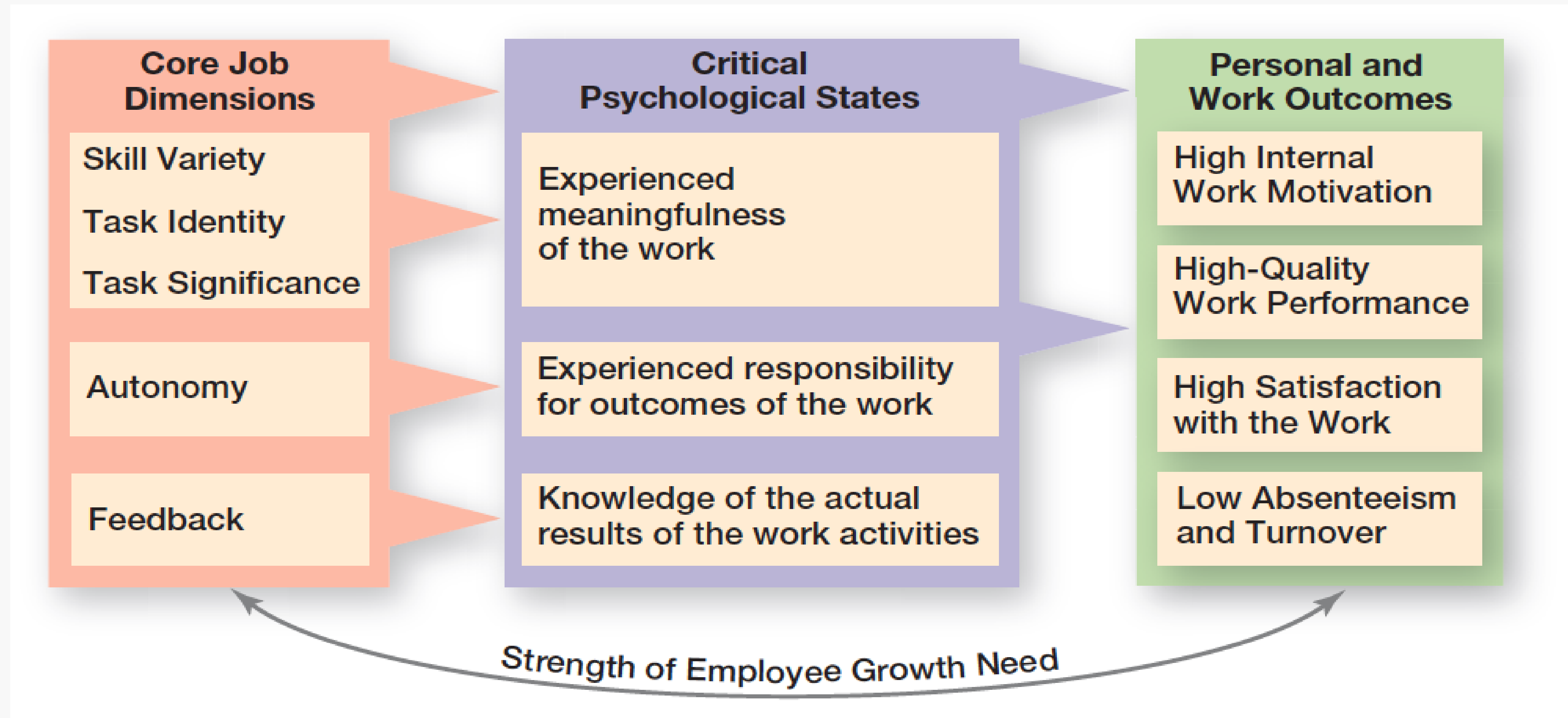


DESIGNING MOTIVATING JOBS (2 OF 2)

- **Job enrichment:** the vertical expansion of a job by adding planning and evaluating responsibilities
- **Job depth:** the degree of control employees have over their work
- **Job characteristics model (J C M):** a framework for analyzing and designing jobs that identifies five primary core job dimensions, their interrelationships, and their impact on outcomes



JOB CHARACTERISTICS MODEL



EQUITY THEORY (1 OF 2)

- **Equity theory:** The theory that an employee compares his or her job's input-outcomes ratio with that of relevant others and then corrects any inequity
 - If an employee perceives their ratio to be equitable in comparison to those of relevant others, there's no problem
 - However, if the ratio is inequitable, they view themselves as under-rewarded or overrewarded



EQUITY THEORY (2 OF 2)

- **Referents:** the persons, systems, or selves against which individuals compare themselves to assess equity
- **Distributive justice:** perceived fairness of the amount and allocation of rewards among individuals
- **Procedural justice:** perceived fairness of the process used to determine the distribution of rewards



EQUITY THEORY

Perceived Ratio Comparison^a

$$\frac{\text{Outcomes A}}{\text{Inputs A}} < \frac{\text{Outcomes B}}{\text{Inputs B}}$$

Employee's Assessment

Inequity (underrewarded)

$$\frac{\text{Outcomes A}}{\text{Inputs A}} = \frac{\text{Outcomes B}}{\text{Inputs B}}$$

Equity

$$\frac{\text{Outcomes A}}{\text{Inputs A}} > \frac{\text{Outcomes B}}{\text{Inputs B}}$$

Inequity (overrewarded)

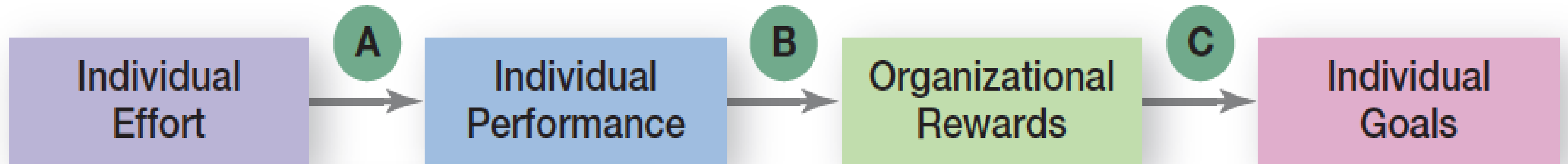


EXPECTANCY THEORY

- **Expectancy theory:** the theory that an individual tends to act in a certain way based on the expectation that the act will be followed by a given outcome and on the attractiveness of that outcome to the individual



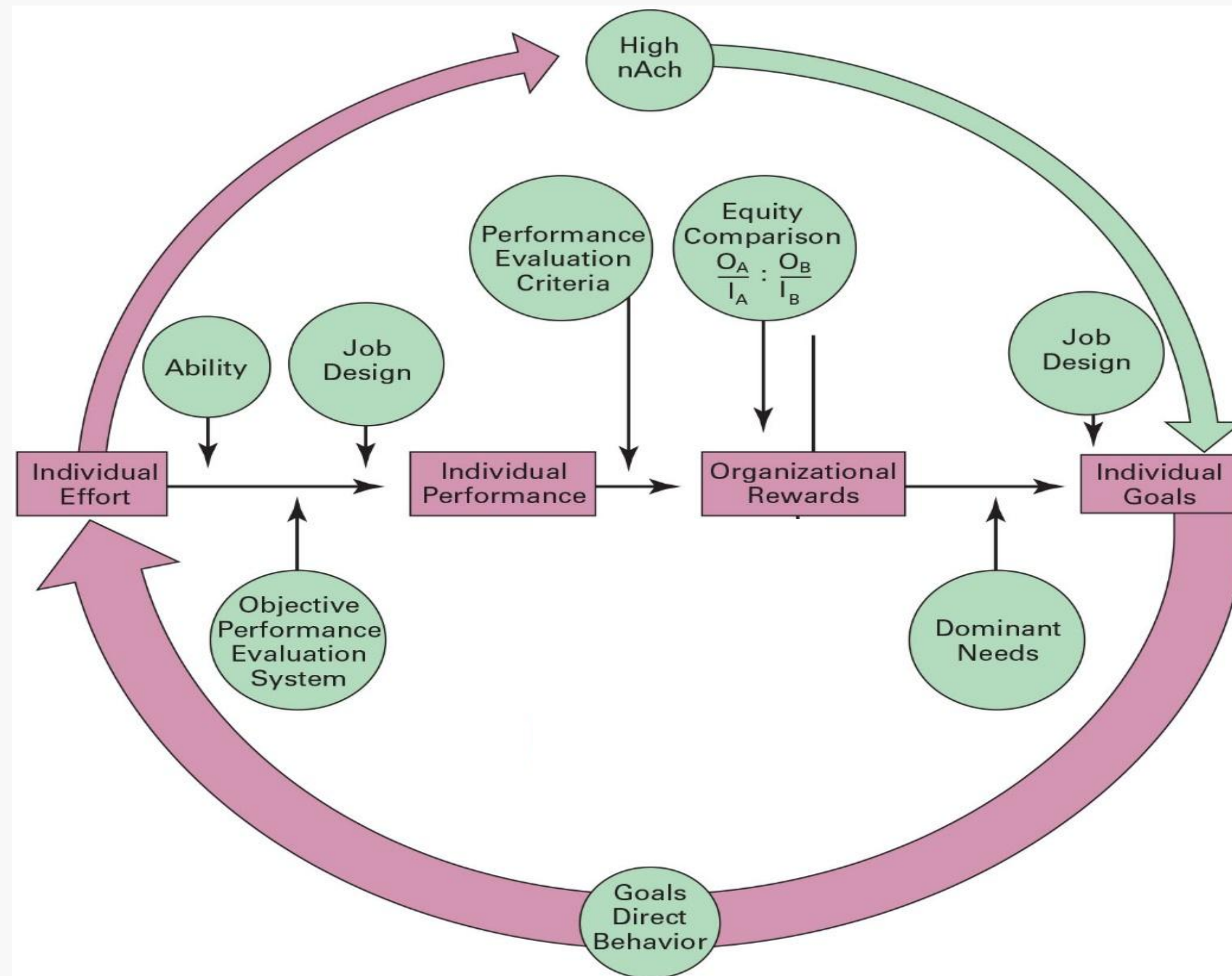
EXPECTANCY MODEL



- A** = Effort–performance linkage
- B** = Performance–reward linkage
- C** = Attractiveness of reward



INTEGRATING CONTEMPORARY THEORIES OF MOTIVATION



A MORE RECENT THEORY OF MOTIVATION

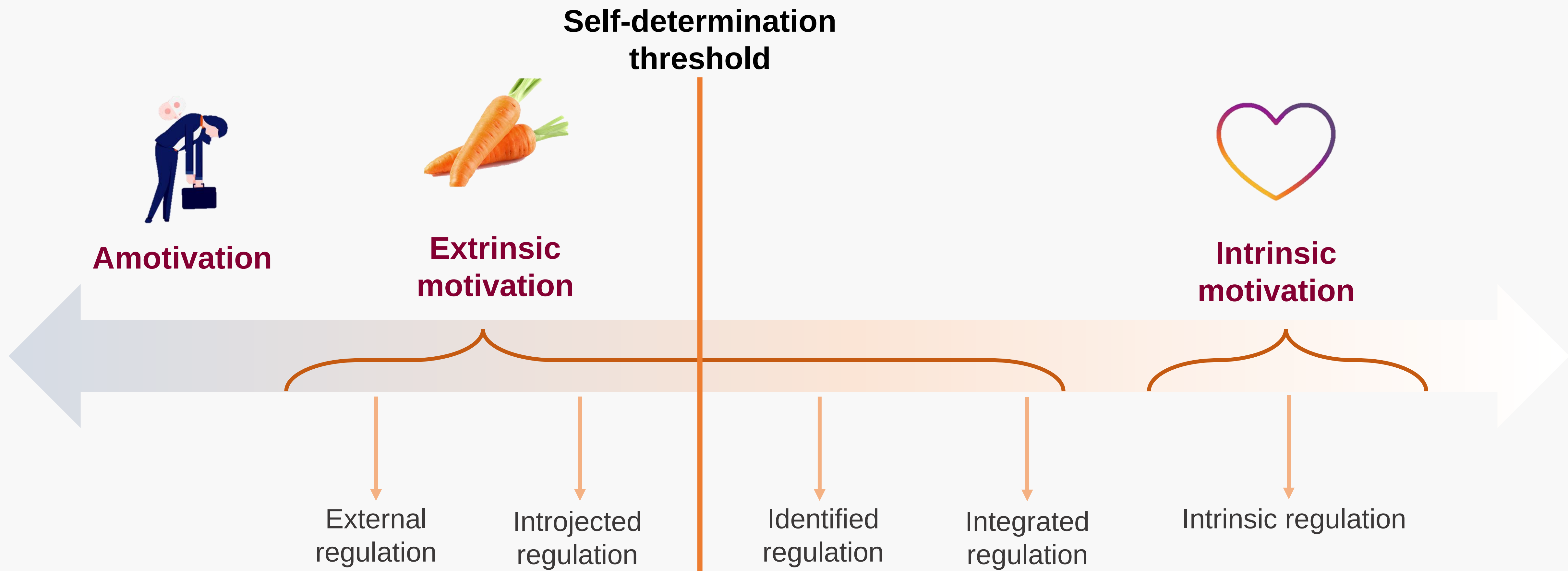


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SELF-DETERMINATION THEORY (SDT)





BASIC PSYCHOLOGICAL NEEDS



- “satisfaction of the three psychological needs will enhance employees’ **intrinsic motivation**” (Gagné & Deci, 2005, p. 337)
- Combined, they will enhance positive work outcomes such as job satisfaction, effective performance, organizational citizenship behaviors and well-being.

MOTIVATION IN THE ALGORITHMIC MANAGEMENT ERA



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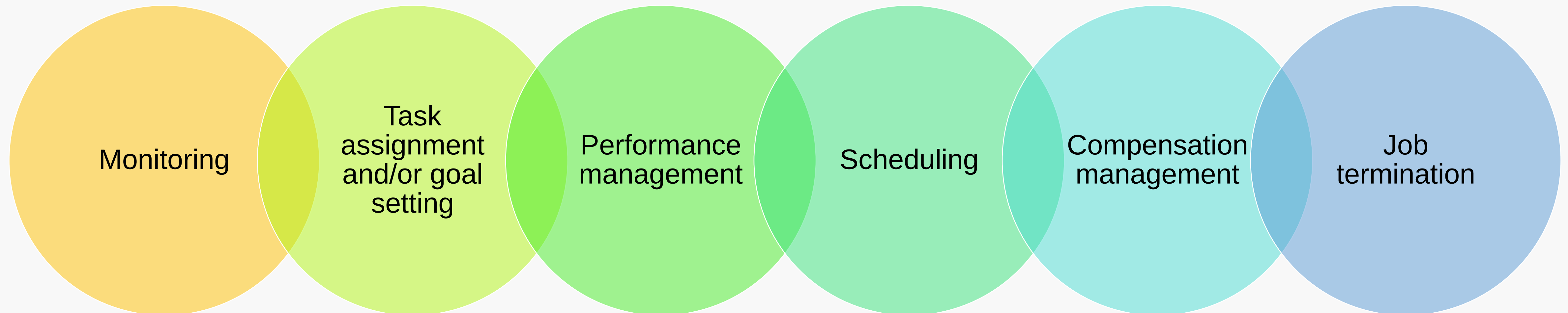
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ALGORITHMIC MANAGEMENT IN ORGANIZATIONS

Organizations use algorithmic management to perform six management functions:



WHAT DOES THAT MEAN FOR MOTIVATION?

- **Monitoring:** Decreases autonomy and negatively affects employees' intrinsic motivation.
- **Task assignment and/or goal setting:** Tends to simplify work, making it less motivating (low need for competence).
- **Performance management:** Negatively affects autonomous motivation and can foster a competitive climate.
- **Scheduling:** Can be unpredictable and thus impede workers' relatedness at home and at work.
- **Compensation management:** Pay-for-performance is linked to decreases in autonomy feelings.
- **Job termination:** Work deactivation because of "low performance" impedes workers' autonomy and feelings of competence.



MOTIVATION-ENHANCING ALGORITHMIC MANAGEMENT

Motivation-enhancing algorithmic management

System Characteristics

- Ensuring transparency
- Keeping humans in the loop

Policies and Practices

- Limiting surveillance and monitoring
- Managing productivity fairly
- Maintaining pay stability
- Providing constructive feedback
- Preserving relationships

Psychological needs

Autonomy

Competence

Relatedness

Self-determined motivation

Slides partly adapted from Robbins, S. P., Coulter, M. A. & Long, L. K. (2024). Management (16th Global Edition).

THANK YOU



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